



SMARTPHONES

- Remove customs duty on mechanical sub-components; ₹4,000 duty cap on ₹20,000-plus handsets
- Abolish 8.25 per cent customs duty on resin, lens, mesh, adhesive, sponge and film
- Roll back GST on smartphones to 12 per cent from 18 per cent

Create 'Not Manufactured in India' category for components to prioritise the import of critical components

Rationalise the taxation structure on high-end smartphones from the current 22 per cent import duty apart from 18 per cent GST, which make them one of the favoured playgrounds of smugglers

—Arnab Dutta



TELECOM

Duty exemptions on key telecom equipment for 5G roll-out. Furthermore, to fast-track 5G roll-out, standardise right of way charges and applications for operators across states

Reduce licence fees—operators pay 8 per cent of their adjusted gross revenue as licence fee, of which 5 per cent goes toward the Universal Service Obligation Fund (USOF) and 3 per cent to the exchequer; nearly 49 per cent of USOF remains unutilised

Refund input tax credit against GST paid on telecom towers

Bring in PLI schemes to encourage domestic manufacturing of equipment

Exempt GST for satellite launch service providers

—Manish Pant



ENTERTAINMENT

The Film and Television Producers Guild of India seeks a longer tax holiday period, lower rates, weighted deductions, subsidies, etc., for film exhibitors to help it recover from Covid-19, enable it to increase penetration of screens in Tier II and III cities, and encourage VFX and animation

The new concessional tax rate applicable to manufacturing companies should be made applicable to the film exhibition/production industry

The PHD Chamber of Commerce and Industry has also sought a tax holiday for FY23 and FY24 for industries such as hotels, travel and cinema exhibition

Roland Landers, CEO of All India Gaming Federation, expects a progressive GST treatment for the online gaming industry

—Vidya S.



INFRA

Road & Highways: Increase capital outlay for roads and highways. Exempt or reduce capital gains tax or interest income on infrastructure investment trusts

Railways: Increase budgetary allocation to the Indian Railways for additional capacity creation; up to ₹2 lakh crore outlay for the sector

Airports: Extend the timeline for monetisation of 14 airports and the divestment of Airports Authority of India's stake in existing airports

Ports & Shipping: Announce tax incentives to attract PPP investments for the ports sector

Power: Provide access to cheaper capital, PLI and elongated waiver of operational charges for renewable energy equipment manufacturing

—Manish Pant